

Absolutely — **piece** is a very strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...but for a **piece** I would look at every day, I think it would be worth it.”

Here **piece** means **an individual work of art**. But the word also commonly means **a part of something, an item/object, a written or musical work, a game piece, a weapon in slang, and a measured portion**.

Word family: **piece**

Base word: piece

Plural: pieces

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞 , 較少見)

Meaning in your passage: **piece = individual work of art — 一件作品 ; 一幅作品**

Your sentence:

> “...for a **piece** I would look at every day...”

Here **piece** means:

> **one individual work of art, especially a painting, sculpture, or designed object.**

繁體中文 :

一件個別的藝術作品

Natural translation:

> “...for a piece I would look at every day...”

「如果是一件我每天都會看的**作品**.....」

So here:

> **piece = 一件藝術作品**

1. **piece = one part of something larger — 一部分 ; 一塊 ; 一片**

The core physical meaning.

Practice 1

> “A small **piece** of glass broke off.”

「一小**片玻璃**掉了下來。」

Practice 2

> “She cut the paper into several pieces.”

「她把紙剪成幾**片 / 幾塊**。」

piece = 從一個較大的整體中分出來的一部分

Natural Chinese depends on object:

- * 一塊
- * 一片
- * 一段
- * 一部分

2. **a piece of + uncountable noun** = 一份 / 一件 / 一條.....

A major grammar function: **piece** makes many uncountable nouns countable.

Practice 3

> “He gave me a **piece of advice**.”

「他給了我一**個建議**。」

Practice 4

> “I found an interesting piece of information.”

「我找到了一**項有趣的資訊**。」

a piece of + uncountable noun = 把不可數概念量化成一個單位

Common:

- * a piece of advice
- * a piece of information
- * a piece of news
- * a piece of furniture

* a piece of equipment

Very high-value grammar point.

3. **piece = individual object/item — 一件東西；一件物品**

A broad object meaning.

Practice 5

> “This is an unusual **piece**.”

「這是一件很特別的**物品**。」

Practice 6

> “Each piece was carefully labelled.”

「每一**件物品**都被仔細標示。」

piece = 一個獨立的物件，尤其當種類或名稱不重要時

4. **piece = work of art — 藝術作品**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 7 — Original

> “For a **piece** I would look at every day, I think it would be worth it.”

「如果是一件我每天都會看的**作品**，我覺得還是值得。」

Practice 8

> “This is one of the artist’s best-known pieces.”

「這是這位藝術家最著名的**作品**之一。」

piece — art = 一件個別的藝術創作

Can refer to:

- * painting
- * sculpture
- * installation
- * design object

5. **piece = musical composition — 樂曲；曲子**

A major arts meaning.

Practice 9

> “She played a beautiful **piece** on the piano.”

「她用鋼琴演奏了一首優美的**樂曲**。」

Practice 10

> “This piece was written for violin.”

「這首**曲子**是為小提琴創作的。」

piece — music = 一首完整的音樂作品

So:

> a piece of music

> = 一首 / 一段音樂作品

6. **piece = written article/work — 文章；作品**

A major publishing/media meaning.

Practice 11

> “She wrote a short **piece** about the exhibition.”

「她寫了一篇關於展覽的短**文**。」

Practice 12

> “The newspaper published an opinion piece.”

「報紙刊登了一篇**評論文章**。」

piece — writing = 一篇獨立的文章、評論或文字作品

Common:

* news piece

* opinion piece

* feature piece

7. **piece = performance/work in dance/theatre — 表演作品；節目**

A broader artistic sense.

Practice 13

> “The dancers performed a new **piece**.”

「舞者表演了一個新的**舞蹈作品**。」

Practice 14

> “The final piece lasted twenty minutes.”

「最後一個**表演作品**長達二十分鐘。」

piece = 一個獨立的藝術 / 表演作品

This shares the same “individual work” concept as art and music, so I would not over-split them conceptually.

8. **piece = portion/serving of food — 一塊；一片；一份**

A very common everyday meaning.

Practice 15

> “Would you like a **piece** of cake?”

「你想吃一**塊蛋糕**嗎？」

Practice 16

> “He ate a piece of bread.”

「他吃了一**片 / 塊麵包**。」

piece = 食物被切開或分成的一個部分

9. **piece = one unit of a set/game — 棋子；遊戲配件**

A common game meaning.

Practice 17

> “Move your **piece** forward two spaces.”

「把你的**棋子 / 遊戲棋**向前移兩格。」

Practice 18

> “One chess piece was missing.”

「少了一隻**棋子**。」

piece — game = 棋盤遊戲中可移動的一個單位

10. **piece = component/part of equipment — 零件；部件**

A practical/mechanical sense.

Practice 19

> “This small **piece** belongs to the frame.”

「這個小**零件**是畫框的一部分。」

Practice 20

> “Several pieces were missing from the machine.”

「機器少了幾個**部件**。」

piece = 機械、設備或物件中的一個組成部分

11. **piece = item of clothing/furniture/equipment — 一件衣物 / 家具 / 設備**

A common classifier-like use.

Practice 21

> “That chair is a beautiful **piece of furniture**.”

「那張椅是一件漂亮的**家具**。」

Practice 22

> “This is an expensive piece of equipment.”

「這是一件昂貴的**設備**。」

****piece of + noun = 一件某類物品****

Especially useful because:

* furniture

* equipment

are normally uncountable.

12. **piece = bit of evidence/information — 一項；一則**

A very common abstract quantifier use.

Practice 23

> “The police found an important **piece of evidence**.”

「警方找到了一項重要的**證據**。」

Practice 24

> “That was a useful piece of information.”

「那是一項很有用的**資訊**。」

****piece of + abstract noun = 一項個別資料 / 證據 / 內容****

13. ****piece = part of a whole idea/story — 一段；一部分****

Practice 25

> “That is only one ****piece**** of the story.”

「那只是整件事的其中一****部分****。」

Practice 26

> “We are still missing an important piece of the puzzle.”

「我們仍然缺少拼圖中的一個重要****部分 / 關鍵線索****。」

****piece = 構成整體理解或事件的一個部分****

14. ****piece = puzzle piece — 拼圖塊；拼圖的一塊****

Practice 27

> “I found the last ****piece**** of the puzzle.”

「我找到拼圖最後一****塊****。」

Practice 28

> “Two pieces do not fit together.”

「這兩塊拼圖****拼不起來****。」

****piece — puzzle = 拼圖中的一小塊****

15. ****piece = coin (較舊式 / 特定表達) — 硬幣；錢幣****

A lexicalized use in compounds.

Practice 29

> “He found an old gold **piece**.”

「他找到一枚舊**金幣**。」

Practice 30

> “A fifty-cent piece rolled under the table.”

「一枚五十分**硬幣**滾到桌下。」

piece = 某種面值 / 材質的一枚硬幣

Usually in:

* fifty-cent piece

* gold piece

16. **piece = gun (俚語) — 槍**

A slang sense worth recognizing.

Practice 31

> “The police found a **piece** in the car.”

「警方在車內發現了一把**槍**。」

Practice 32

> “He was carrying a piece.”

「他身上帶著一把**槍**。」

piece — slang = 槍械

Register:

* slang

* informal

* recognition only, not a neutral standard term

17. **piece = one person viewed evaluatively (俚語/貶義) **

There are slang uses referring to a person, often objectifying or insulting. These are modern but not particularly useful for your course, so I would **flag but not curate deeply**.

Examples include expressions like:

- * a piece of work
- * a piece of ...
- * slang referring to attractiveness

For database quality, I would keep these under **idiomatic/slang expressions**, not as core bare-**piece** meanings.

18. **piece together** = combine parts to understand/reconstruct — 拼湊；整理出

This is a phrasal verb, so by our rule I'll only flag it briefly:

- > **piece together information**
- > = 把零散資料拼湊起來

It is common, but should remain in the phrasal-verb layer.

19. **in one piece** = 完好無損；平安無事

A useful fixed expression.

Practice 33

> "The painting arrived **in one piece**."

「這幅畫**完好無損地**送到了。」

Practice 34

> "We were relieved to get home **in one piece**."

「我們很慶幸能**平安無事地**回到家。」

in one piece = 沒有破損；人也可指安全無恙

20. **to pieces = 成碎片；徹底地**

Another fixed expression.

Practice 35

> “The glass fell and broke **to pieces**.”

「玻璃掉下來摔得**粉碎**。」

Practice 36

> “The old paper was falling to pieces.”

「那張舊紙已經**破爛不堪**。」

to pieces = 分裂成很多碎片；完全破碎

21. **piece by piece = 一件件地；逐步地**

A common expression.

Practice 37

> “They restored the painting **piece by piece**.”

「他們**逐步 / 一部分一部分地**修復那幅畫。」

Practice 38

> “The story was revealed piece by piece.”

「故事是**一點一點地**被揭開的。」

piece by piece = 分成小部分逐步進行

22. **a piece of work = 某類人 / 作品（依語境）**

A highly context-sensitive expression.

Practice 39

> “That sculpture is an impressive **piece of work**.”

「那座雕塑是一件令人印象深刻的**作品**。」

Practice 40

> “He is a real piece of work.”

「他真是個**很難搞 / 很有一套的人**。」

The second is informal and often negative or sarcastic.

piece of work can mean:

* 一件作品

* 一個性格麻煩 / 特別的人

Very context-dependent.

Important distinction: **piece** vs **part**

part

broad:

one portion/component of a whole.

piece

often:

a separate, countable bit/object/portion.

> part of the machine

> = 機器的一部分

> a broken piece of the machine

> = 機器掉下來的一塊 / 零件

They overlap, but **piece** often feels more concrete and separable.

Important distinction: **piece** vs **item**

piece

can mean one individual object/work.

item

more neutral/catalogue-like:
one entry/object in a list or set.

> piece of art
> = 一件藝術作品

> item in the collection
> = 館藏中的一項物件

Piece is more natural for artworks; **item** is more administrative.

Important distinction: **piece vs work**

piece

= one individual creation.

work

can mean:

- * one creation
- * artistic output generally

> a piece by Monet
> = Monet 的一件作品

> Monet's work
> = Monet 的作品整體 / 創作

So:

> piece = 個別作品
> work = 可指個別作品，也可指整體創作

Important distinction: **piece vs painting**

painting

specifically:
a work made with paint.

piece

broader:
any individual artwork.

So:

> a Monet painting
> = 一幅 Monet 畫作

> a Monet piece
> = Monet 的一件作品，類型可由語境決定

In your passage, because the object is clearly a Monet painting/reproduction, **piece** means **作品**.

Important distinction: **piece vs artwork**

artwork

explicitly identifies something as art.

piece

more general but very natural in art contexts.

> artwork
> = 藝術作品

> piece
> = 一件作品

Piece can also be music, writing, furniture, equipment, etc., so context does more work.

Important distinction: **piece vs portion**

piece

often a physically separated part.

****portion****

often an amount allocated or served.

> piece of cake

> = 一塊蛋糕

> portion of cake

> = 一份蛋糕 / 一份量

Different emphasis.

Important distinction: ****piece vs bit****

****piece****

neutral and broad.

****bit****

smaller, more informal.

> a piece of paper

> = 一張 / 一片紙

> a bit of paper

> = 一小片紙

For abstract nouns:

> a piece of advice

> is standard

> a bit of advice

> is more conversational and means “a little advice”.

Important distinction: ****piece of advice / information / news****

These nouns are normally uncountable.

Correct:

- > a piece of advice
- > two pieces of advice

Not:

- > *an advice* ❌

Correct:

- > a piece of information
- > three pieces of information

Not:

- > *three informations* ❌

Correct:

- > a piece of news

Not:

- > *a news* ❌

This is a very important grammar point.

Important distinction: ****piece of furniture/equipment****

Again, these are normally uncountable:

- > a piece of furniture
- > two pieces of furniture
- > a piece of equipment
- > several pieces of equipment

Not normally:

- > *furnitures* ❌
- > *equipments* ❌

Excellent MCQ material.

Important distinction: **piece — art vs music vs writing**

Same noun, same broad semantic concept:

> **one individual creative work**

Art

> an art piece

> = 一件藝術作品

Music

> a piano piece

> = 一首鋼琴曲

Writing

> an opinion piece

> = 一篇評論文章

These are best treated as domain-specific realizations of one underlying meaning, not three unrelated senses.

Important distinction: **piece — object vs portion**

Object:

> “This piece is valuable.”

= 這件物品很有價值。

Portion:

> “Give me a piece of cake.”

= 給我一塊蛋糕。

One means **individual item**; the other means **part cut/separated from a whole**.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **piece — part of a whole** = 一部分 / 一塊 / 一片
* **a piece of + uncountable noun** = 一項 / 一件 / 一則
* **piece — individual object** = 一件物品
* **piece — artwork** = 一件藝術作品
* **piece — music** = 一首 / 一段樂曲
* **piece — writing** = 一篇文章 / 文字作品
* **piece — performance** = 一個表演作品
* **piece — food portion** = 一塊 / 一片 / 一份
* **piece — game** = 棋子 / 遊戲配件
* **piece — component** = 零件 / 部件
* **piece of furniture/equipment** = 一件家具 / 設備
* **piece of evidence/information** = 一項證據 / 資訊
* **piece — part of story/idea** = 一部分
* **puzzle piece** = 拼圖塊
* **coin piece** = 硬幣
* **piece — slang gun** = 槍
* **in one piece** = 完好無損 / 平安無事
* **to pieces** = 粉碎 / 破成碎片
* **piece by piece** = 逐步 / 一部分一部分
* **piece of work** = 一件作品；非正式可指難搞 / 特別的人

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
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piece — part	從較大整體中分出來的一個部分	
a piece of + uncountable noun	把不可數概念表示成一個可數單位	
piece — object	一個獨立的物件 / 物品	
piece — art	一件個別的藝術作品	
piece — music	一首 / 一段完整的音樂作品	
piece — writing	一篇獨立的文章、評論或文字作品	
piece — performance	一個獨立的舞蹈 / 表演作品	
piece — food	從食物整體切開 / 分出的一部分	
piece — game	棋盤遊戲中可移動的一個單位	
piece — component	機械、設備或物件中的一個組成部件	
piece of evidence/information	一項個別證據 / 資訊	
piece — puzzle	拼圖中的一小塊	
piece — coin	某種面值或材質的一枚硬幣	

piece — slang	非正式俚語中的槍械	
in one piece	沒有破損；人則指安全無恙	
piece by piece	把整件事拆成小部分逐步處理	

For your original sentence

> “That is not exactly cheap, but for a **piece** I would look at every day, I think it would be worth it.”

The exact meaning is:

piece = 一件個別藝術作品；這裡指那幅 Monet 《Water Lilies》的高品質複製畫

Natural translation:

> **「那當然不算便宜，但如果是一件我每天都會看的作品，我覺得還是值得。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **piece of cake** → 一塊蛋糕
- > **piece of advice** → 一個建議
- > **piece of information** → 一項資訊
- > **piece of furniture** → 一件家具
- > **art piece** → 一件藝術作品
- > **music piece** → 一首樂曲
- > **opinion piece** → 一篇評論文章
- > **chess piece** → 棋子
- > **machine piece** → 零件 / 部件
- > **in one piece** → 完好無損
- > **piece by piece** → 逐步、一部分一部分地